

another anywhere in the world. Users can retrieve data, start applications on remote servers, and communicate in real time across the Internet.

Web Server

A computer that delivers or serves up Web pages. Every Web server has an IP address and possibly a domain name. For example, if you enter the URL <http://www.thinkdigit.com/index.html> in your browser, this sends a request to the server whose domain name is thinkdigit.com. The server then fetches the page named index.html and sends it to your browser. Any computer can be turned into a Web server by installing server software and connecting the machine to the Internet.

Web Server Program

A program that understands HTTP and responds to resource requests from Web browsers using that protocol. A Web server program must run on a host that is addressable with an IP address, which is found using its corresponding DNS host name. The machine that runs the Web server program is often referred to informally as a Web server, although the machine may be running many other programs at the same time.

WWW

The World Wide Web, or simply the Web. The Web, which was invented by physicists at the European Community's particle physics research centre CERN, is more a conceptual construct than a physical entity. All the Web servers on the Internet, taken together, constitute the WWW, but there is no central administration.